

Wednesday, 12 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Clear 33° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 34° 15°	MANCHESTER Overcast 33° 17°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 26° 17°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

It looks like Summer 2026 is on track to be the UK's hottest on record, according to the Met Office.

They say we only need average conditions for the rest of August to break the record, which was actually set just last year. So, more heatwaves could be on the way!

WEATHER · UK
- 2

With a significant eclipse on the horizon, people are scrambling to get their hands on specialist viewing glasses, and stocks are running low.

It's set to be the UK's most significant eclipse since 1999, and online retailers are reporting that specialist glasses are all but sold out. Better get searching if you want to see it safely!

SCIENCE · UK
- 3

England is set to become one of the first countries in the world to eliminate hepatitis C, a dangerous liver virus.

New figures show that the country is on track to achieve this major health milestone. It's fantastic news in the fight against this serious disease.

HEALTH · UK
- 4

Prime Minister Andy Burnham has announced that councils will be given more powers to tackle the spread of vape and betting shops.

The PM stated that town centres have been 'hollowed out' by decades of decline. The new measures aim to help revitalise high streets across the country.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

London Heathrow Airport is no longer Europe's busiest, having been overtaken by Istanbul.

Heathrow saw its passenger numbers on Middle East routes fall by over 20% year-on-year. It marks a significant shift in European air travel.

TRAVEL · UK

What's coming up

1 **Football YouTuber John Nellis, known for his videos with stars like Cristiano Ronaldo, is joining the Strictly Come Dancing line-up!**

Nellis boasts 20 million followers across his social media channels. It'll be interesting to see if his fancy footwork on the pitch translates to the dancefloor.

ON AIR – Do you think a football YouTuber will be a hit with the Strictly judges, or will he be more of a novelty act?
TV · AUTUMN

2 **KT Tunstall is returning to the Edinburgh Fringe 30 years after her first appearance, with a ground-breaking musical.**

Her new play, 'The Singer', is making waves by bringing deaf and hearing performers together on stage. It sounds like a truly innovative and inclusive production.

ON AIR – What a fantastic idea to bring deaf and hearing performers together! Do you think more shows should embrace this kind of inclusivity?
THEATRE · AUGUST

3 **A 'spectacular' Game of Thrones stage spin-off has just opened at the home of Shakespeare.**

Theatre critics are calling it a worthy addition to the epic fantasy franchise. Fans of Westeros might want to book their tickets now!

ON AIR – Are you a Game of Thrones fan? Would you be tempted to see a stage version, or do some stories work better on screen?
THEATRE · NOW

4 **Rising singer Kamal has opened up about the 'scary' moment he approached Dave for his debut album.**

The London-based musician is aiming for 'honesty' in his new record, as well as in his popular TikTok content. It sounds like he's putting his heart into this one.

ON AIR – It takes guts to reach out to a huge star for your debut album. Have you ever taken a big risk that paid off?
MUSIC · SOON

5 **Andrea Bocelli is set to play in Wales for the first time in 22 years, at the Principality Stadium in Cardiff.**

The Italian tenor will be performing in May 2027, so mark your calendars! It's a rare chance to see a true legend.

ON AIR – Andrea Bocelli in Wales after 22 years! Are there any artists you'd travel far to see perform live, even if it's a long wait?
MUSIC · 2027

On the schedule

1 **Great Britain's Amy Hunt has sprinted to her first major gold medal, winning the 100m at the European Athletics Championships in Birmingham.**

It was a fantastic performance, seeing her storm to victory on home soil. A brilliant moment for British athletics!

ON AIR – What a moment for Amy Hunt! Do you think home advantage makes a real difference to athletes' performances?

ATHLETICS · UK

2 **Great Britain has also won its first medal of the European Athletics Championships, taking silver in the mixed 4×400m relay.**

They finished second to Norway in a thrilling race in Birmingham. A great start to the championships for Team GB!

ON AIR – Another medal for Team GB! What's your favourite relay event to watch – is it the excitement of the 4×100m or the tactics of the 4×400m?

ATHLETICS · UK

3 **Rocky Flintoff, son of cricket legend Andrew, has hit his first professional century for Lancashire at just 18 years old.**

It's a huge milestone for the young all-rounder, following in his famous father's footsteps. What a talent!

ON AIR – Like father, like son! Do you think it's harder or easier for young athletes to succeed when they have famous sporting parents?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Norway's Jakob Ingebrigtsen has made a sensational comeback from injury to win 5,000m gold at the European Championships.**

After almost a year out, he fought back from 'the lowest of lows' with a stunning late burst of pace in Birmingham. A truly inspiring victory!

ON AIR – What an incredible comeback from injury! What's the most memorable sporting comeback you've ever witnessed?

ATHLETICS · UK

5 **Chelsea will face Spanish side Real Sociedad in the Women's Champions League third qualifying round.**

The first leg of the tie is scheduled for August 26th. It's a big test for Chelsea as they look to progress in Europe.

ON AIR – Chelsea facing Real Sociedad – do you think the Women's Champions League is getting more competitive each year?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are discovering the joy of 'micro-gardening' in unexpected places.**
From miniature herb gardens on windowsills to tiny succulent arrangements in teacups, people are finding creative ways to bring a touch of green indoors, no matter how small their space.
- 2 The surprising trend of 'listening to nature sounds' for relaxation is growing.**
Beyond white noise, more people are tuning into recordings of gentle rain, distant waves, or birdsong to unwind and improve focus, proving that sometimes the best soundtrack is nature itself.
- 3 Nostalgia for 'retro board games' is bringing families together.**
Classic games like Ludo, Snakes and Ladders, and even more complex strategy games from yesteryear are making a comeback, offering a screen-free way for all ages to connect and compete.
- 4 A new appreciation for 'traditional British puddings' is bubbling up.**
Think sticky toffee pudding, jam roly-poly, and treacle sponge! Home bakers and cafes are rediscovering these comforting classics, proving that sometimes the simplest desserts are the best.
- 5 The 'joy of simple crafting' is being rediscovered by many.**
From knitting and crocheting to paper crafts and model making, people are finding solace and satisfaction in creating things with their hands, away from screens.
- 6 There's a charming new focus on 'local historical plaques and markers'.**
Many are enjoying walks around their towns and villages, taking the time to read the blue plaques and local historical signs, uncovering fascinating stories right on their doorstep.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'writing postcards' is making a delightful return.**
Instead of quick texts, people are taking the time to choose a scenic postcard and pen a thoughtful message, making holidays and special moments feel a little more tangible and personal.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to find a matching pair of socks, even though we know it's a bit of a gamble?

ANSWER: JUST SNIFFING THEM TO SEE IF THEY'RE CLEAN!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING THE BISCUITS INTO A PERFECTLY AESTHETIC STACK.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'unusual items' we keep in a drawer or cupboard that we just can't bring ourselves to throw away, even though we rarely, if ever, use them.**

What's the most peculiar or seemingly useless thing you've held onto for years, and why do you think you can't part with it? Maybe it's a nostalgic relic, or perhaps you just think 'it might come in handy one day'!

- **Think about a 'small, everyday moment' that always brings a little bit of unexpected joy to your day.**

Is it the sound of the postman, spotting a specific bird in your garden, or perhaps the precise way your tea brews in the morning? What tiny, seemingly insignificant thing consistently brightens your routine?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which they use to sniff out nectar from flowers.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as 3D wallpaper.
- Wombat poop is cube-shaped.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death by burning down rat-infested buildings.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The sound of crinkling cellophane can be louder than a jet engine if measured at the source.

On this day

Day 224 of the year, 141 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Euplius; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Milan; Christian feast day: Herculanius of Brescia; Christian feast day: Pope Innocent XI. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1988 — Tyson Fury, English boxer
- 1949 — Mark Knopfler, Scottish-English singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1972 — Del the Funky Homosapien, American rapper
- 1927 — Porter Wagoner, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2007)
- 1975 — Casey Affleck, American actor
- 1954 — Pat Metheny, American jazz guitarist and composer
- 1999 — GK Barry, social media star and presenter
- 1980 — Dominique Swain, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1944 — Waffen-SS troops massacre 560 people in Sant'Anna di Stazzema.
- 1976 — Between 1,000 and 3,500 Palestinians are killed in the Tel al-Zaatar massacre, one of the bloodiest events of the Lebanese Civil War.
- 1952 — The Night of the Murdered Poets: Thirteen prominent Jewish intellectuals are murdered in Moscow, Russia, Soviet Union.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1985 — Japan Air Lines Flight 123, a Boeing 747, crashes into Osutaka ridge in Gunma Prefecture, Japan, killing 520, becoming the worst single-plane air disaster.
- 1944 — Nazi German troops end the week-long Wola massacre, during which time at least 40,000 people are killed indiscriminately or in mass executions.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1976 — Between 1,000 and 3,500 Palestinians are killed in the Tel al-Zaatar massacre, one of the bloodiest events of the Lebanese Civil War.
- 1950 — Korean War: Bloody Gulch massacre: Seventy-five American POWs are massacred by the North Korean Army.

- 1953 — Thermonuclear bomb testing: The Soviet atomic bomb project continues with the detonation of "RDS-6s" (Joe 4) using a "layered" scheme.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 225 of the year, 140 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Benedetto Sinigardi; Christian feast day: Benildus Romançon; Christian feast day: Cassian of Imola; Christian feast day: Clara Maass (Lutheran Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — James Morrison, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1921 — Jimmy McCracklin, American blues/R&B singer-songwriter and pianist (died 2012)
- 1961 — Dawnn Lewis, American actress
- 1964 — Debi Mazar, American actress
- 1982 — Sebastian Stan, Romanian-American actor
- 1959 — Bruce French, English cricketer and coach
- 1962 — John Slattery, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1970 — Seana Kofoed, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1960 — The Central African Republic declares independence from France.
- 2008 — Russo-Georgian War: Russian units occupy the Georgian city of Gori.
- 1913 — First production in the UK of stainless steel by Harry Brearley.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1954 — Radio Pakistan broadcasts the "Qaumī Tarāna", the national anthem of Pakistan for the first time.
- 1940 — World War II: The German Luftwaffe launches an air operation, codenamed Adlertag, during the Battle of Britain in an attempt to destroy the British Royal Air Force.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)